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who accompanies most of his guests on their travels. His recreational vehicle, Taurus, is leased for approximately ₹4,500 per person per night, although final costing is done once the itinerary is finalised. It can accommodate up to eight people and has roof-top tents as well as tents on the side. It's equipped with all camping equipment such as chairs, tables, hammocks, etc. There are solar panels to help charge mobile phones and cameras. The onboard crew helps prepare all meals. While Green Dot has fixed itineraries for Ladakh and Himachal in the summer, you can always get your itinerary customised.

Jolly's Carawander offers caravans in two sizes—one sleeps maximum eight people, while the other sleeps six people at most. The larger one is priced at ₹22,000 a night and the smaller one for ₹18,000 a night. This includes the fee for the driver and the helper. Both come fully

equipped with queen-sized beds, a kitchenette and a washroom.

Since caravanning is still in its nascent stages in India, it faces problems like lack of camping sites. Jolly has tied up with several locations in Rajasthan and Uttarakhand where the caravan can be parked safely at night. In case you are visiting a place not on the list, Jolly's team will find a safe parking spot in that area. "We have connections with hotels and petrol pumps where we park for the night," he says.

While Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, Ladakh and Uttarakhand are popular destinations in the north, Karnataka and Maharashtra are popular down south. Last year, Maharashtra Tourism Development Corporation collaborated with Mumbai-based Motohome to encourage caravan travel. Motohome offers a luxury van with proper beds, kitchen, toilet, etc., for ₹21,000 a

day and a self-driven camper van for ₹4,500 a day. Bengaluru-based Luxe Campers is the country's first caravan community. On its site you can rent and lease caravans. There are also suggested itineraries.

Although Carvaa Travelers is based in Delhi, it provides you doorstep service anywhere in the country. It charges 50 per cent of the per day cost to transfer the vehicle to your home along with fuel charges and state/toll taxes.

Carvaa Travelers can also customise and design a caravan for you for around ₹8 lakh and it takes them over two months. Ideally a Force Traveller or a Tata Winger works well as a customised caravan, suggests Joshi.

For your next vacation, it might be a good idea to explore the country in your home-on-wheels. **BT**

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